

Murder Mystery

Dinner Party 2026



Dr. Art E. Fact

The Meridian Museum

October 30, 2026 / Private player packet / 1 of 12

INTRODUCTIONS



Dr. Art E. Fact

Professor of Art History & Provenance Scholar

Art has never met a footnote he could not lengthen. Art has built a career tracing the lives of objects through wars, estates, auctions, private collections, and suspicious gaps in paperwork.

- Supervises **Reed DeLabel**'s doctoral research and sends drafts back covered in notes.
- Secretly infatuated with the enigmatic energy of **Dada DiCapo**. Will she notice him?
- Trusts only **Chip Patina** to say when the physical evidence contradicts Art's theory.

ACTING TIPS

Intense, professorial, curious, occasionally pedantic, sincerely excited by evidence.

YOUR INTRODUCTION / READ THE BOX ALOUD

I'm Dr. Art E. Fact. I bring decades of scholarship and a footnote for almost every possible dinner conversation. Looking forward to intellectual discussions tonight!

Continue to your private briefing on page 3. Keep the packet facing you.



Dr. Art E. Fact

Behind the portrait

Your grievance with Grant

Grant suppressed your research showing that two objects in his collection passed through a dealer linked to questionable wartime sales. He threatened to release correspondence suggesting you had overstated another provenance claim if you challenged him publicly.

Your other secret

One celebrated article of yours does contain an inference you stated too confidently. The main thesis still stands, but the mistake would be humiliating.

Conversations to start

- Ask Reed DeLabel what he has discovered in the accession records.
- Determine whether Claire O'Scuro commissioned outside provenance research.

If a named guest is absent, speak to someone else. Your printed account may conceal another scandal, even if you are innocent. Stick to it during the hearings; save corrections for Coming Clean.

Memorize your animal and return the slip. When the host announces the selected animal, use IF MURDERER if it matches yours; otherwise use IF INNOCENT. Never read an IF heading aloud.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



The museum has misplaced its paperwork. Naturally.

Sixteen numbered envelopes are hidden around the house. These three hints lead to three different hiding places. Leave the furniture and household objects where they are. Bring an envelope to the Evidence Table; read and share the discovery inside.

- 1 *Look behind a painting rather than into its scenery.*
- 2 *The household's Bible has received a very unofficial insert.*
- 3 *Your reflection cannot look up far enough to see what rests on the mirror.*

Already found? Read that discovery at the Evidence Table, then try another hint. Ask for help reaching a hiding place; nobody needs to climb. You may investigate together.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



Dr. Art E. Fact

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 6, then choose the next guest. The host tracks turns.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Tess Tament

What did Grant's financial plans threaten to take from you?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Sue Venir

What did Grant pressure you to approve or overlook?

Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid

What did Grant demand over a sale or purchase?

Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Drew Conclusions

How did Grant threaten your work or reputation?

Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel / Justin Tyme

What unwelcome research did Grant want suppressed?

Barb Dwyer / Paige Turner / Faye Stop

What did Grant ask you to hide, and why?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Al Baster / Minnie Malist

What last-minute demand put your work at risk?

Mona Lott / Elle Loominate / Robin Banks

What dispute made you want Grant's announcement stopped?

Anya Tique / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher

What past decision was Grant threatening to expose?

Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Anne E. Dote

How did Grant's decisions threaten your livelihood or work?

Your speaking box is on page 6. Turn only within this act.



Dr. Art E. Fact

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

Grant threatened to release a letter showing I overstated a provenance inference. I did overstate it. The broader thesis survives, but one cannot ask a footnote to carry an entire reputation. He wanted my wartime-sales research suppressed in return for silence. I would rather correct a sentence than pretend the archive never existed.

IF MURDERER

I overstated an inference in my article. Grant obtained the correspondence and offered to keep it private if I abandoned the wartime-sales research. The error is embarrassing. His bargain was worse. I had spent years finding the documents he intended to reduce to a troublesome misunderstanding.

You can ask someone to repeat a detail. Discuss your suspicions after everyone has answered.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



Dr. Art E. Fact

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 8, then choose the next guest. The host tracks turns.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Tess Tament

Where were you before the toast, and why?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Sue Venir

What were you checking in the exhibition, and when?

Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid

What occupied you before Grant's private toast?

Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Drew Conclusions

Where did your work take you before the toast?

Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel / Justin Tyme

What were you examining before the unveiling, and when?

Barb Dwyer / Paige Turner / Faye Stop

What did you observe while the toast was prepared?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Al Baster / Minnie Malist

What last-minute work were you doing, and where?

Mona Lott / Elle Loominate / Robin Banks

Where did you go before the toast, and why?

Anya Tique / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher

What drew you to the exhibition before the toast?

Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Anne E. Dote

What were you arranging before Grant drank?

Your speaking box is on page 8. Turn only within this act.

ACT II: OPPORTUNITY



Dr. Art E. Fact

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

I examined the inscription before the alcove closed, then went to the library broadcast desk. I had promised a short research update. It became a correction. My moderator tried to stop me at the advertised length, which was a hopeful reading of the word 'short.' I remained until the transmission ended.

IF MURDERER

I recorded the research update in the library earlier and sent it for broadcast. Before the toast I compared the manifest and article at the gallery table. I wanted the transfer dates beside each other when Grant challenged the finding. He had developed a selective relationship with chronology.

You can ask someone to repeat a detail. Discuss your suspicions after everyone has answered.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



Dr. Art E. Fact

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 10, then choose the next guest. The host tracks turns.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Tess Tament

What did you handle or conceal during setup?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Sue Venir

What materials or records passed through your hands?

Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid

What did you borrow, conceal or change tonight?

Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Drew Conclusions

What did you alter that could look suspicious?

Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel / Justin Tyme

What did you discover or conceal in your work?

Barb Dwyer / Paige Turner / Faye Stop

Which objects or records need your explanation?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Al Baster / Minnie Malist

What changed during setup, and what did you do?

Mona Lott / Elle Loominate / Robin Banks

What might someone misinterpret about your preparations?

Anya Tique / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher

What part of your past or preparation needs explaining?

Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Anne E. Dote

What passed through your hands that matters tonight?

Your speaking box is on page 10. Turn only within this act.



Dr. Art E. Fact

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

I read my erratum live. The library archive covers 6:39 to 6:45 and shows the article beside the manifest in my hands. I had described an inference as a fact. Correcting that sentence does not supply the missing export papers, and it does not remove the dealer from the shipping chain.

IF MURDERER

I prepared an erratum for the recorded update. The article and manifest were in my folder, with a marked passage Grant wanted removed from the next lecture. He had confused a correction to my inference with withdrawal of the whole finding. I was quite prepared to explain the difference in public.

The sixteen discoveries and five reports remain at the Evidence Table.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
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ACCUSATIONS



Dr. Art E. Fact

Your ballot

Choose one attending guest. Explain your accusation in your own words. Fold this loose page writing inward and give only the ballot to the host. Keep your packet for Coming Clean. Votes lock when all ballots are collected.

Your character name

I accuse

Why? Motive, evidence and any unresolved contradiction

Best Actor

Best Costume



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



The last word

Read only when the host calls you. Top three suspects read first. If none confesses, the host calls the selected animal to stand. Use your own role's box; keep every other word private.

IF INNOCENT / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

The article needed correction, and I made it publicly. The continuous library transmission keeps me at its fixed desk while Grant's glass was open. The 1988 manifest deserves an inquiry regardless of my embarrassment. I concealed an overstatement; I did not poison the man who tried to make it my price for silence.

IF MURDERER / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

The library update was a recording. While it played, I took the conservation sample and wiped Grant's empty coupe with the cloth from my archive folder. He was going to bury years of research under my one bad sentence. I chose to silence him instead. There is no scholarly qualification that makes that choice smaller.

Every selected suspect gets their final word.